

# Automation Workflow v2

Draft → Critique → Revise pipeline for job application proposal sections / emails

## 1. Pipeline & Purpose

Pipeline chosen: Draft, Critique, Revise. Applied to writing job application proposal sections and cover emails, one of the highest-frequency, highest-stakes writing tasks in my current job search. The pipeline turns a job posting and my resume into a tailored, self-checked draft, while keeping me as the final decision-maker on what changes get made.

## 2. Step Diagram

| STEP 1 GATHER                                   | STEP 2 DRAFT                                        | STEP 3 CRITIQUE                                     | STEP 4 REVISE (human-gated)                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Job posting + resume → requirements/match table | Match table → rough draft (proposal section/ email) | Draft + requirements → critique memo (no rewriting) | Draft + critique + MY accept/reject decisions → final version |

Steps 1–3 run automatically in sequence inside one Claude Project. Step 4 has a deliberate human checkpoint: I read the critique memo and decide what to accept before any rewriting happens, rather than letting the model auto-revise.

## 3. Build: Claude Project Configuration

### Project knowledge (uploaded once)

- Resume/background document
- One past proposal section, as a tone/style reference

### Project instructions

This project helps draft, critique, and revise job application proposal sections and emails. The uploaded resume/background doc is the source of truth for my specialties and experience. Never invent experience I don't have. Work in the 4-step sequence I specify – don't skip ahead to drafting or revising unless I've explicitly run that step's prompt.

### Prompt 1 — Gather

Here is a job posting: [paste]  
Extract the core requirements from this posting. For each requirement, check my background doc and note whether I have a genuine, specific match (name the actual experience/skill), a partial match, or no match. Output this as a table: Requirement | My Match | Evidence. Flag any requirements where I have no match – I need to know these honestly.

## Prompt 2 — Draft

Using the requirements/match table above, write a [proposal section / cover email] for this application. Lead with the strongest matches. Don't address requirements where I have no real match — don't pad or overstate. Keep it to [X words/paragraphs].

## Prompt 3 — Critique

Critique the draft above against the original requirements table. Check:

1. Does it address every requirement I have a genuine match for?
2. Any claim that's generic rather than backed by specific evidence from my background?
3. Tone — does it sound like me / appropriate for this employer?
4. Length and structure.

Do NOT rewrite anything. Just list problems, organized by severity.

## Prompt 4 — Revise

Here's the critique. I'm accepting these points: [list]. I'm rejecting/skipping these: [list]. Revise the draft to address only the accepted points.

## 4. Five Real Runs

All five runs used real, currently-open job postings I am applying to. Times are wall-clock minutes:seconds, including my own read-throughs and decisions at each step, not just model generation time.

| Run | Job Posting                                                         | Step 1 | Step 2 | Step 3 | Step 4 | Total | Notes / Failures                                                                                                                                             |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | Data Analyst — RK Infotech LLC                                      | 2:10   | 1:01   | 1:29   | 2:31   | 7:10  | None                                                                                                                                                         |
| 2   | Business Analytics Intern — Bright Network Consulting               | 2:09   | 1:01   | 1:26   | 2:51   | 7:17  | Draft placed dashboarding under my ML internship (Flyrank) — I do have dashboarding experience, but from a different project; misattributed, not fabricated. |
| 3   | Data Science Intern — Bright Network Consulting                     | 1:20   | 0:52   | 0:50   | 2:28   | 5:30  | None                                                                                                                                                         |
| 4   | Data Entry Associate — Sundayy                                      | 1:12   | 0:51   | 1:00   | 1:59   | 5:02  | None                                                                                                                                                         |
| 5   | Data Analyst Intern — FairChild Institute of Information Technology | 0:39   | 0:40   | 0:33   | 1:29   | 3:21  | None                                                                                                                                                         |

## 5. Time Accounting

- One-time Claude Project setup (uploading resume, writing 4 prompts, testing): 1:01
- Manual baseline (one full application, drafted start to finish by hand, timed with a stopwatch): 15:19
- Average pipeline run across all 5 runs: 5:40 (340 sec average of 7:10, 7:17, 5:30, 5:02, 3:21)
- Average time saved per application vs. manual: 9:39, roughly a 63% reduction
- Setup cost amortizes almost immediately: it was recovered within the very first run (1:01 setup vs. 9:39 saved on Run 1 alone), and adds negligible overhead across the other four.
- Trend across runs: time dropped from 7:10 (Run 1) to 3:21 (Run 5) as the job postings required less back-and-forth and I got faster at making accept/reject decisions in Step 4 — meaning real-world savings likely improve further with practice.

## 6. Known Failure Points & Required Human Review

### What broke

- Run 2: the draft misattributed a real skill (dashboarding) to the wrong job context (my Flyrank ML internship, where I didn't actually do dashboarding) instead of the project where I actually did it. This was a misattribution, not a fabrication — the underlying skill is real, but Step 2 placed it under the wrong evidence source from my background doc.
- Step 3's critique did not catch the Run 2 misattribution on its own — I caught it manually while reviewing before Step 4. This means the critique step cannot be trusted as a full fact-check pass; it is stronger at catching missing requirements and tone/length issues than at verifying factual attribution to the correct job.

### What a human must still check, every run

- Every factual claim in the draft against the actual resume/background doc — Step 1's match table can misfile evidence under the wrong context, and Step 3 does not reliably catch this.
- Tone and voice — the critique's tone judgment is generic; final read for 'does this sound like me' is still mine.
- The accept/reject decision in Step 4 itself — this is intentionally kept manual and is the single largest time cost in the pipeline (avg. ~2 min of the ~5:40 total), which is appropriate given it's the only step with real judgment calls.
- Nothing in this pipeline verifies the job posting itself is accurate or still open — that remains entirely on me.